JOHN KAPANTZAKIS

Senior Frontend Engineer

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Senior frontend engineer with 12+ years of experience building web products, currently on the React frontend of Netdata Cloud: AI-assisted observability, Model Context Protocol (MCP) integration and performance work on data-intensive UIs. Contributor to Hotwire Turbo, co-organiser of SKG JS, the Thessaloniki JavaScript community.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer, **Netdata** Feb 2023 – Present

Open-source, real-time observability platform. Frontend of Netdata Cloud, a large, data-intensive React application.

- Built frontend capabilities for Netdata's AI assistant, evolving it from a basic chat interface to persistent LLM conversations powered by Netdata-specific tools and investigation workflows. Also implemented frontend support for Model Context Protocol (MCP), allowing users to connect external tooling.
- Optimized data processing and React rendering to improve performance and eliminate unnecessary remounts.
- Cut reported frontend CI runtime by about 60% through Jest test sharding and test-reliability fixes.
- Built the foundational Dynamic Configurations UI and continued evolving it to support complex, dynamically generated configuration forms, using the react-jsonschema-form library.
- Helped build end-to-end AI Insights investigation reports (generation, rendering, scheduling) and contributed to enterprise identity features: SCIM, SSO, role and room mappings, and label-driven room membership.

Senior Frontend Developer, **Adzuna** Feb 2022 – Jan 2023

Job search engine used by 15M+ jobseekers a month across 20 countries.

- Built Labour Market Intelligence, a new data product, from zero to launch in under a year on Next.js, in a team of three (one product manager, two developers).
- Built the product's interactive charts and maps with Apache ECharts, visualising hiring demand, salaries and trends across regions.
- Shipped search, grouping and filtering by location, sector, salary and other dimensions, so users could explore labour-market data for multiple countries.

Software Engineer, **Skroutz** Jun 2020 – Jan 2022

One of Greece's leading e-commerce marketplaces. Partners department: tooling for merchants.

- Developed and maintained the merchant platform (orders, payments, daily operations) with Ruby on Rails and Hotwire Turbo server rendering, using React for selected views.
- Contributed two features to Hotwire Turbo that shipped in Turbo 7 and were credited in the release announcement: the turbo:frame-render event and target elements on fetch events.
- Published two articles on the Skroutz engineering blog, on progressive data loading in React and lazy loading with Hotwire.

Full Stack Developer, **EpsilonNet** Sep 2014 – May 2020

Greek business-software company. Epsilon ESS, an employee self-service web platform on ASP.NET and C#.

- Progressed from junior web designer to full-stack developer responsible for the product's frontend, implementing features end to end from C# backend to TypeScript frontend.
- Introduced TypeScript, webpack and Redux-managed asynchronous views into a legacy ASP.NET Web Forms frontend, and added unit tests on both sides (Mocha and Chai, xUnit).
- Built a Node.js and Handlebars CLI that generates the boilerplate for a new form: the ASP.NET user control and async handler, the TypeScript page script and Redux state, and the C# data models.

OPEN SOURCE & COMMUNITY

Hotwire Turbo, Open-source contributor 2021

Two pull requests shipped in Turbo 7, credited by name in the release announcement.

PR #327 · PR #367 · Turbo 7 announcement

SKG JS, Thessaloniki JavaScript Meetup, Co-organiser — Apr 2025 – Present

Organising meetups and talks for the JavaScript community in Thessaloniki. Speaker: "What's new in React 19", SKG JS Meetup #3, Apr 2025.

skgjs.gr · Talk

Stack Overflow, 11,600+ reputation

stackoverflow.com/users/1221792/kapantzak

SELECTED WRITING

When to Use NoSQL vs SQL: The Ultimate Guide for Choosing a Database — Scalable Path, 2021

TypeScript or Flow: Which Is Better? — Scalable Path, 2020

JS illustrated: The event loop — Medium, 2019

JS illustrated: Promises — Medium, 2019

Hotwire @ Skroutz: Lazy load data with minimum effort — Skroutz Engineering, 2021

Automating boilerplate code generation with Node.js and Handlebars — DEV Community, 2020

Using Redux in a legacy ASP.NET Web Forms project — DEV Community, 2019

SKILLS

Languages	JavaScript, TypeScript, C#, Ruby, HTML, CSS
Frontend	React, Next.js, Redux, Hotwire Turbo, webpack
Backend	Node.js, ASP.NET / ASP.NET Core, Ruby on Rails, SQL Server
Testing & delivery	Jest, Testing Library, RSpec, Mocha, xUnit, CI pipelines, Git
AI	Claude Code and other AI coding agents, custom skills, CLAUDE.md / AGENTS.md project instructions

EDUCATION

MSc in Applied Informatics, University of Macedonia — 2015 – 2018

MSc in Informatics and Management, Aristotle University of Thessaloniki — 2008 – 2010

BSc in Economic Science, Aristotle University of Thessaloniki — 2001 – 2006